

TRIP: Making a Difficult Ask

Sometimes you have to make a tough ask — a late night, weekend work, etc. The way you ask shapes how it's received. Here's a framework for asking well.

T

Thank them

It goes a long way.

R

Give a reason

Why are you asking for this, and why now?

I

Acknowledge the impact

Show that you see what this costs them.

P

Include praise

Affirm what makes them right for this ask.

Example

"I know this might mess up your evening (I), but the client moved up their deadline and it took me by surprise (R). I'll need that memo tonight. Coming to you with this because I know you have the skills to handle this the right way (P). Thanks for your help (T)."